Zhiyuan Yao

Postdoctoral Researcher, Hebrew University of Jerusalem
Curriculum Vitae

Contact Information

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Research Appointments

Postdoc, Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Israel
10/2022 - Present
Advisor: Nir Mandelker, Avishai Dekel

Education

Joint Ph.D, Max Planck Institute for Astrophysics, Germany
04/2021 - 03/2022
Advisor: Volker Springel, Max Gronke

Ph.D, Astronomy, Shanghai Astronomical Observatory, Chinese Academy of Sciences, China
09/2016 - 06/2022
Advisor: Feng Yuan

Bachelor, Astronomy, University of Science and Technology of China, China
09/2012 - 06/2016

Research Interests

Galaxy formation and evolution at cosmic dawn; gas accretion at cosmic noon; black-hole accretion and AGN feedback; circumgalactic medium; multiphase hydrodynamics; cold streams and virial shocks; turbulence and mixing; numerical simulations; computational astrophysics

Honors & Awards

2024, Rosenblum prize
2021-2022, Sino-German Joint PhD Exchange Program (Shanghai Astronomical Observatory and Max Planck Institute for Astrophysics, 04/2021 - 03/2022)
2020, Academic Scholarship of University of Chinese Academy of Sciences

Publications

First-author publications

Yao Z., Dekel A., Teyssier R., Somerville R., Mandelker N., Andalman Z., Steinwandel U. P., Li Z.
"The MAGE Project: Size Evolution and Disk Formation in Massive Galaxies at Cosmic Dawn", submitted to MNRAS (2026); arXiv:2610.29070

Yao Z., Mandelker N., Oh S. P.
"Cold stream penetration of virial shocks: fragmentation, coagulation, and disruption in the hot circumgalactic medium", MNRAS, 552, stag1914 (2026)

Yao Z., Mandelker N., Oh S. P., Aung H., Dekel A.
"Effects of cloud geometry and metallicity on shattering and coagulation of cold gas, and implications for cold streams penetrating virial shocks", MNRAS, 536, 3053 (2025)

Yao Z., Yuan F., Ostriker J. P.
"Active galactic nucleus feedback in an elliptical galaxy with the most updated AGN physics: parameter explorations", MNRAS, 501, 398 (2021)

Yao Z. & Gan Z.
"Hot gas flows on a parsec scale in the low-luminosity active galactic nucleus NGC 3115", MNRAS, 492, 444 (2020)

Collaborative publications

Chen, H.-Z., Li, Z., Dekel, A., **Yao Z.** et al.
"Feedback-Free Star Formation in Clusters within a Galaxy Simulated at High Resolution in Cosmic Dawn", MNRAS, 550, stag1214 (2026)

Dekel, A., Dutta Chowdhury, D., Lapiner, S., **Yao Z.** et al.
"From Feedback-Free Star Clusters to Little Red Dots via Compaction", ApJ, 1010, 208 (2026)

Dekel, A., Mandelker, N., Li, Z., **Yao Z.** et al.
"From FFB Starbursts at Cosmic Dawn to Quenching at Cosmic Morning: Hi-z Galaxy Bimodality", MNRAS, 544, 160 (2025)

Yang, G. et al. (incl. **Yao Z.**)
"Do current X-ray observations capture most of the black-hole accretion at high redshifts?", ApJ, 921, 170 (2021)

Invited & Seminar Talks

10/2026, CCA-NYC Community Galaxy Seminar, Flatiron Institute, New York, United States
07/2026, DUSC Seminar, University of Washington, Seattle, United States
12/2025, Tel Aviv University Seminar, Tel Aviv, Israel
10/2021, MPA Institute Seminar, Garching, Germany

Conference Contributions

08/2026, Galaxy Formation Workshop, Santa Cruz, United States
07/2026, The 71st Annual Meeting of the Israel Physics Society, Jerusalem, Israel
11/2025, Modelling of Multiphase Astrophysical Media, Ringberg, Germany
08/2025, Galaxy Formation Workshop, Santa Cruz, United States
07/2025, Cosmic Ecosystems, Waterloo, Canada
08/2024, Galaxy Formation Workshop, Santa Cruz, United States
05/2023, Modelling of Multiphase Astrophysical Media, Kochel, Germany
08/2022, Galaxy Formation Workshop, Santa Cruz, United States
07/2021, Ringberg Retreat, Munich, Germany
Earlier (2018–2020): 4 contributed talks at meetings in China and Germany.

Technical Skills

Hydrodynamic simulation codes: AREPO, RAMSES, ZEUS–MP/2
Programming: Python, C, C++, Fortran, MPI/OpenMP
Analysis tools: yt, NumPy, SciPy, Matplotlib
High-performance computing: distributed-memory simulations on large HPC systems

Mentoring

2025 – Aviad Leibovich (B.Sc. student), Hebrew University of Jerusalem

Professional Service

Organizer, Astrolunch Seminar Series, Hebrew University of Jerusalem
Referee, Astronomy & Astrophysics (A&A)

References

Nir Mandelker — Hebrew University of Jerusalem — nir.mandelker@mail.huji.ac.il

Peng S. Oh — University of California, Santa Barbara — peng@physics.ucsb.edu

Rachel Somerville — Flatiron Institute — rsomerville@flatironinstitute.org

Romain Teyssier — Princeton University — teyssier@princeton.edu